

NPTEL ONLINE CERTIFICATION COURSES

Employment Communication **- A Lab based course**

Dr Seema Singh
Department of Humanities & Social Sciences
IIT Kharagpur

Lecture 21: The Cover Letter

CONCEPTS COVERED

Writing Cover Letters

Cover Letter Example

Types of Cover Letters

Cultural considerations

The persuasive covering letter



How to write a cover letter

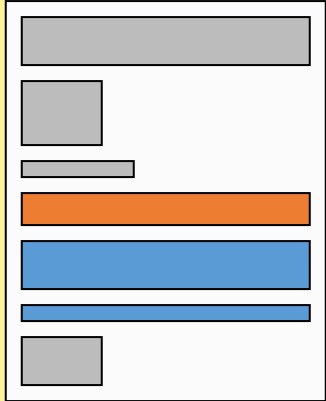
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1MD_U-YpD6c



Writing Cover Letters

1. Gain attention in the opening
2. Select content
3. Organize for conviction
4. Drive for action in the close

Cover Letter Example – Opening (1 of 5)



[Sender's Address]

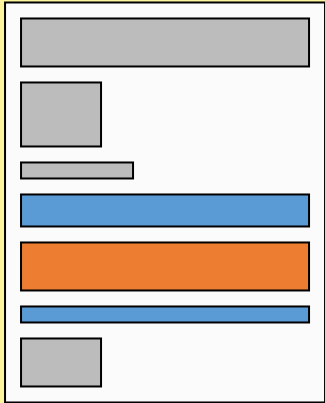
[Date]

[Receiver's Address]

Dear Mr. Guthrie:

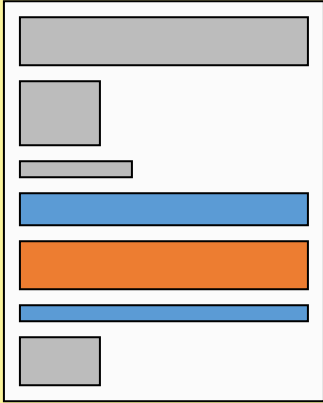
Does your interest in employing an accountant, as indicated by your advertisement in today's issue of *The Post*, center on finding a person who has had some experience in petroleum accounting, is college trained in accounting, and has demonstrated the ability to work with others?

Cover Letter Example - Body (2 of 5)



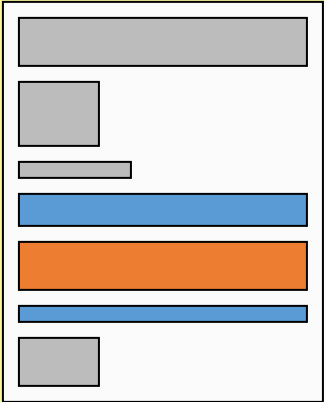
With a background of three years as a part-time employee of the State Comptroller of Public Accounting and the State Auditor's office, and with four years' specialized training in the College of Business Administration at State University, I am the person who meets your requirements. As an auditor in both the state departments mentioned above, I participated in audits of the books of several oil firms and gained some familiarity with petroleum accounting procedures which should increase my usefulness in future work of this type.

Cover Letter Example - Body contd. (3 of 5)



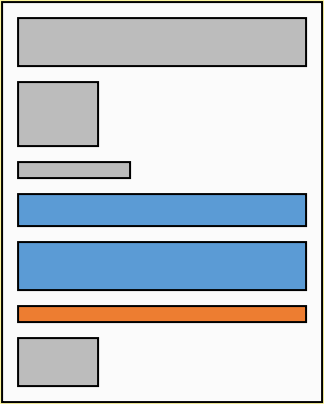
In my intensive coursework at the University, I studied several phases of accounting (including petroleum, fiduciary, cost, and systems as well as theory and auditing) with the intention of obtaining a comprehensive and well-integrated background for competent work in the petroleum field. Please look at the attached resume to note the additional courses with which I rounded out my training. The sincerity of my study efforts is evidenced by the B.B.A. degree with honors I was awarded this June.

Cover Letter Example - Body contd. (4 of 5)



With a view to the value of human relations in business, I actively participated in organizations such as Sigma Nu (social fraternity), intramural volleyball, Men's Chorus, and Delta Sigma Pi (professional fraternity). Through these associations I learned a lot about people and how to work with them. I am confident that I could work effectively with your accounting department staff.

Cover Letter Example – Closing (5 of 5)



As my interests lie in useful and satisfying work in the field of petroleum accounting, may I meet you personally and talk with you? I can make myself available at any date convenient for you.

Sincerely,

[Your typed name]

enclosure

5 Steps to an Incredible Cover Letter

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mxOli8laZos>

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Writing Cover Letters

- Be specific
- Include salary
- Keep e-mail short
- Aim for high quality

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Types of Cover Letters

- Solicited
- Unsolicited
 - Getting attention
 - Building interest
 - Increasing desire
 - Motivating action

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Cultural Considerations

- The right style and approach
- Proper tone and format

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How To Write A Cover Letter (Example Included)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jHg0b7Nai6c>



References

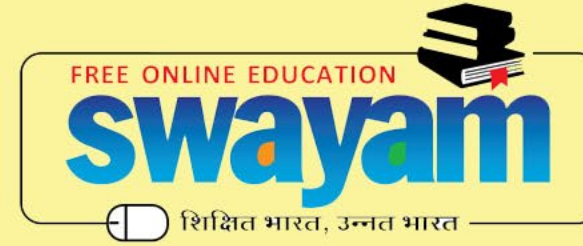
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2. Skills Development for Business & Management Students – Kevin Gallagher, 2001: OUP
3. Strategies for Engineering Communication – Whitmore & Whitmore, John Wiley: 2003
4. Basic Business Communication: Skills for empowering the Internet Generation - Lesiker & Flatley, TMH: 2002
5. Business Communication Today – Bovee, Thill & Schatzman: Pearson Education, 2003
6. www.youtube.com





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Lecture 22: CV writing Lab Session 1

CONCEPTS COVERED

Examination of the CVs of :

1. TWO B.Tech. students, IIT Kharagpur
2. FIFTEEN 1st year Master of Human Resource Management (MHRM) participants,
Department of Humanities & Social Sciences,
IIT Kharagpur



CVs of the following B.Tech. students

1. Arif Raza
2. Bindu Sancheti

References

CVs of the following MHRM 1st year Participants

Alolika Roy

Anupam Dash

Aritra Lahiri

Kaustav Sengupta

Mohd Hashim Ali

Poulami Saha

Purva Shirish Chaudhary



References

CVs of the following MHRM 1st year Participants (contd.)

Rajarshee Tribedi

Reetika Dasgupta

Thorat Akshay Vijay

Tirtha Nandi

Varsha Vijay

Thanvi Ajith

Pooja Khatwani

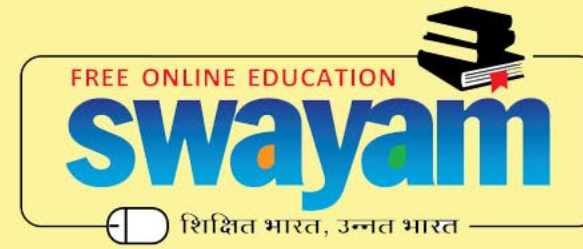
Ankur Agrawal





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Lecture 23: CV writing Lab Session 2

CONCEPTS COVERED

1. **Creating-a-cv-student-worksheet: EMPLOYABILITY SKILLS – CREATING A CV**
2. **CV_writing_(E2)_student_worksheets: Writing a CV**
3. **Case Studies - CV Writing**



Sources acknowledged for Lecture - Lab class 23

1. http://www.macmillanenglish.com/uploadedFiles/www_macmillanenglishcom/Content/Campaigns/life-skills/employability/Creating-a-cv-student-worksheet.pdf
2. [https://esol.britishcouncil.org/sites/default/files/CV_writing_\(E2\)_student_worksheets.pdf](https://esol.britishcouncil.org/sites/default/files/CV_writing_(E2)_student_worksheets.pdf)
3. <https://d2ez4oka28hp4n.cloudfront.net/45dacf5b8e40a8c969d0eec495db2b5f830c5b6b?Key-Pair->

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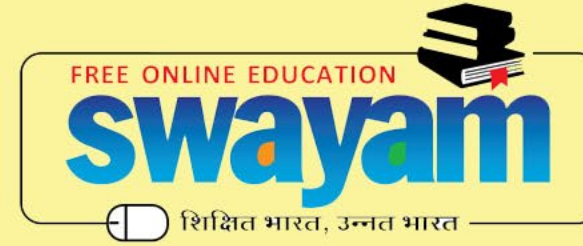
Ankur Agrawal





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**Lecture 24: Fundamentals of Group Discussions
(GDs)**

CONCEPTS COVERED

- Definition
- Qualities looked for in GDs
- Strategies for GDs
- Body Sport for GDs



Group Discussion Strategies and Techniques

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ctj5Vukjlf4>



Group Discussions

To gauge/judge the mettle of a group prior to their entry into any organization, the communication skills of each one of them are tested vis-à-vis other equally, academically, competent candidates.

Qualities looked for in GDs (1 of 5)

1. Leadership Qualities

- Taking Initiative
- Ability to give direction
- Taking the Group along
- Listening
- Goal Fulfillment

Qualities looked for in GDs (2 of 5)

- 2. Knowledge of the Subject Matter**
- Presentation of Details
 - Error- Free Presentations

Qualities looked for in GDs (3 of 5)

3. Analytical Ability

- Use of arguments, examples, logic - how effectively are the same related to the subject matter.

Qualities looked for in GDs (4 of 5)

4. Clarity of Thought

- Distillation of Essentials
- Abandonment of Peripherals

Qualities looked for in GDs (5 of 5)

5. Conviction and Flexibility

- The strength with which the argument is posited
- Flexible in approach to topic

Strategies for GDs (1 of 2)

DOs

1. KISS - Keep It Short & Simple
2. Follow principles of oral communication
3. Make even contributions
4. Conclude periodically
5. Deliberate & be slow in delivering your points
6. Adhere to principles of politeness
7. Substantiate your point with examples and not the other way round

Strategies for GDs (2 of 2)

DON'Ts

1. Speak loudly
2. Adopt a negative stance
3. A casual look
4. Flay hands
5. Talk too fast

Body Sport for GDs (1 of 2)

POSITION

1. Push your body to the back of your chair
2. Keep your hands on your lap right atop the left

SIGNIFICANCE

1. Keeps you alert
2. Indicates that you are a logical person

Body Sport for GDs (2 of 2)

POSITION

3. Keep your legs stationed on the ground; right and left leg intertwined beneath the chair
4. Hand movement should be restricted

SIGNIFICANCE

3. Keeps you firmly positioned
4. Indicates that you do not need hands as props when speaking

Tips for cracking Group Discussions

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TOjZNapdPm8>



References

Select References:

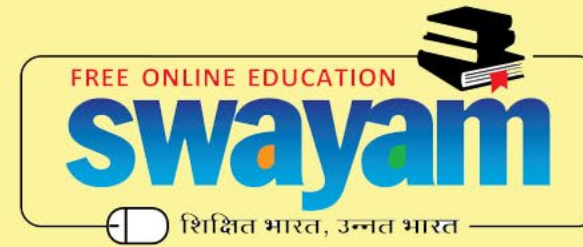
1. Business Communication – Asha Kaul, PHI: 2001
2. www.youtube.com
3. www.google.com





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Lecture 25: Strategies for Success in GDs

CONCEPTS COVERED

- Types of GDs
- Reasons for having a GD
- 10 simple rules to easily crack a GD
- Techniques to initiate a GD and make a first impression
- Skills judged in GDs
- Summary



Group Discussion Tips you should not Miss | Effective Group Discussion

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JREV7-ZkOCk>

Uptill 5-46 only



Types of GDs

1. **Factual Topics**
(The education policy of India, Tourism in India)
2. **(Reservations should be removed, Women make better managers)**
3. **Abstract Topics**
(A is an alphabet, Twinkle Twinkle little star)

Reasons for having a GD

- helps you to understand a subject more deeply
- improves your ability to think critically
- helps the group to make a particular decision
- gives you the chance to hear ideas of the other Discussants
- improves your listening skills
- increases your confidence in speaking
- can change your attitudes

10 simple rules to easily crack a GD

- 1) Keep eye contact while speaking
- 2) Initiate the GD
- 3) Allow others to speak
- 4) Speak clearly
- 5) Make sure to bring the discussion on track
- 6) Positive attitude
- 7) Speak sensibly
- 8) Listen carefully to others
- 9) No need to go into much details
- 10) Formal dress

Techniques to initiate a GD and make a first impression

- i. Quotes
- ii. Definition
- iii. Question
- iv. Shock statement
- v. Facts, Figures, and Statistics
- vi. Short story/Anecdote
- vii. General statement

Don't

- Lose your temper. A discussion is not an argument.
- Shout. Use a moderate tone and medium pitch.
- Use too many gestures when you speak. Gestures like finger pointing and table thumping can appear aggressive.
- Dominate the discussion. Confident speakers should allow quieter discussants a chance to contribute.
- Draw too much on personal experience.
- Interrupt. Wait for a speaker to finish what s/he is saying before you speak.

Skills judged in GDs (1 of 2)

- How good you are at communication with others
- How you behave and interact within a group
- How open minded are you
- How good is your Listening Skill
- How you put forward your views

Skills judged in GDs (2 of 2)

1. Your leadership and decision making skills
2. Your analytical skills and subject knowledge
3. Your problem solving and critical thinking skills
4. Your attitude and confidence

Researched Group Discussions

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ly7drPXqzps>



Summary

- Group discussions have now become a *sine qua non* in various selection procedures.
- Whether it is recruitment in a prestigious firm or admission in an MBA institute, aspiring candidates have to go through the *rigors* of a 'Group Discussion'.
- What exactly is a group discussion? Normally, in a group discussion a leaderless group of 8- 10 candidates is formed, and is given a specific situation to analyze and discuss within a given time limit.
- The number of participants and the time limit given for discussion vary from situation to situation.
- A panel of moderators observes and evaluates them during the course of the discussion.

Summary (contd.)

- Broadly, the moderators assess the candidates on the following points/parameters
 1. Command over spoken language
 2. Knowledge
 3. Convincing ability
 4. Interpersonal skills
 5. Problem solving skills
 6. Conceptualizing skills
 7. Leadership Skills
 8. Body Language
 9. Creativity
 10. Confidence, &
 11. Assertiveness

Summary (contd.)

- A few tips for cracking the Group Discussion are given below:

1. Always be polite: Try to use phrases like: 'I would like to share my views on...' or 'Yes, I agree, but...'
2. If you have understood the topic in the correct way then do initiate the GD. It will show your leadership skills.
3. Never be hesitant to speak if others are speaking. But you need to look for an opportunity to enter into the discussion.
4. Be your natural self. Avoid putting on a show for the moderators.



Summary

(contd.)

5. The score you receive depends both on what you say and how you say it. Your gestures and mannerisms are most likely to reflect your attitude than what you say.

6. Be assertive not dominating

4. Be patient; don't lose your temper.

5. Never get involved in one- to- one discussion with any participant

Summary (contd.)

6. Bring in as many diverse aspects as you can to the discussion.
7. Avoid taking names of the participants. It is good to address them by calling “My dear friend.”
8. Never argue incessantly with any of your group members.
9. Maintain eye contact with as many members of the group as possible.
10. Maintain a positive Talk- listen ratio. Listen –punctiliously

Summary (contd.)

11. Keep your points brief and to the point.
12. Use facts, figures, examples, statistics and data to substantiate your points.
13. Never pin- points any one (with your finger) while speaking during the discussion.
14. Finally, practice makes all human beings perfect.
So, never stop yourself from practicing.

References

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3. Gallagher, Kevin. *Skills Development for Business & Management Students* (Delhi, OUP: 2011)
4. www.youtube.com
5. www.google.com





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